Sangjun (Samuel) Ko

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Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign — Champaign, Illinois
Master of Science in Statistics — August 2025 - May 2027 (Expected)
Bachelor of Science in Statistics (CGPA: 3.92/4.00) — January 2023 - May 2025

- Mathematics Minor

Work Experience

STAT107 Data Science Discovery — Champaign, Illinois
Undergraduate Course Assistant — August 2023 - Present

- Facilitate learning for over 100 students by assisting students in grasping fundamental data science concepts by conducting interactive sessions, and providing clarifications on course materials
- Manage Git for learning platform modifications, benefiting 1000+ students; create, edit, and proofread course materials
- Collaborate with a team of 100+ staff and 2 professors in weekly meetings

STAT443 Professional Statistics — Champaign, Illinois
Undergraduate Course Assistant — January 2025 - Present

- Grade assignments and provide feedback to 20+ students on statistical analysis and consulting using Canvas LMS
- Evaluate 5+ student presentations to ensure alignment with course expectations and grading criteria
- Act as a client in mock consulting projects, providing insights and posing real-world challenges

Applied Technologies for Learning in Arts & Sciences — Champaign, Illinois
AI/ML Intern Team Leader — January 2024 - December 2024

- Lead a team of 5 interns.
- Develop predictive machine learning models with large data sets(100,000+ entries) using Python
- Utilize advanced techniques: XGBoost, Random Forests, Regression, Neural Networks, BERT, Transformers
- Collaborate closely with 3 coordinators in weekly meetings to align project goals and track progress

Projects/Awards

Graduation Prediction Model — September 2024 - December 2024

- Increased AUC score from 0.65 to 0.82 by reducing noise in the dataset through feature engineering and outlier removal across 50,000+ student records
- Built an interactive Streamlit interface with 12 key predictors, enabling real-time graduation predictions for university administrators

3rd Place, 2024 COVID Information Commons Student Paper Challenge — September 2024

- Analyzed the socioeconomic and mental health impacts of COVID-19 in Mexico, identifying that 42% of females and 40% of young adults faced job loss
- Proposed data-driven interventions to support vulnerable groups through geospatial and statistical analysis

Skills

Languages:	English (Fluent), Spanish (Native), Korean (Native), French (Basic), Chinese (Basic)
Computer:	Python (Advanced), R (Intermediate), Git (Intermediate), Tableau (Basic), Office (Advanced)
Certificates:	Data Science DISCOVERY, Data Science Certificate, Coursera Business Analytics Certificate

Community Service and Extracurricular Activities

Consultant in Illinois Business Consulting — September 2024 - December 2024

- Collaborating with interdisciplinary teams to deliver strategic solutions for real-world business challenges, including market analysis, operational optimization, and growth strategy, for clients ranging from Fortune 100 companies to nonprofits

Treasurer in Performance UIUC Touch — February 2023 - May 2024

- Strategically plan and execute 10 fundraising initiatives to support team activities, costumes, and travel expenses, resulting in a 30% increase in available funds compared to the previous year
- Showcase talent by performing at renowned events elevating the visibility of Performance UIUC Touch within the dance community and attracting 100+ new followers on social media platforms

Translator for the US Army — June 2021-December 2022

- Served as a translator for over 2,000 US soldiers and Korean soldiers during joint USFK training exercises
- Assisted newly stationed US soldiers in navigating South Korea,resulting in a 95% satisfaction rate among newly stationed soldiers regarding their acclimation process